

Loshinski's masterpieces

By C.G.S.Narayanan
IM for chess composition

The purpose of this article is to re-visit and analyse a couple of three-move masterpieces of Lev Loshinski, the greatest composer of the last century. The main challenge in magnet theme, named after him, is to ensure logical reasoning so that White's second move must follow Black's first move. Here the whole idea is carried by the need to have a second threat, besides 3.Nh5, which will be fulfilled when the white Knight g3 is captured at black second move.

Lev Loshinski
I prize, Chess in USSR 1947



Mate in three moves

1. Qb1! (2. Sh5+ Kxe4 3. Re3#)
1... Rd5 2. Rd4 (3. exd5, Sh5#)
1... Rd6 2. Rd5 2... Rxg3 3. Bxe5#
1... Rd7 2. Rd6 2... Rxg3 3. Rf6#
1... Rc4 2. Rc3 (3. Sh5#)
1... Rb4 2. Rb3 (3. Sh5#)
1... Ra4 2. Ra3 (3. Sh5#)

What does the great composer wants to show in the three-mover below? There is a set mate provided for the flight -1...Kxc3 2.d4+ Kxd4/Qe3 2.Rd3/Qxd3. This is discarded for the key 1.Rh4! creating a powerful battery but c3 is still vulnerable so the threat has to be clever 2.Qe7 followed by 3.Ne2, with 2...Kxc3 now met by 3.Qb4

Lev Loshinski
1 HM, Trud 1950



Mate in three moves

1...Kxc3 leads to 2.Qd2+.The thematic variations see the BQ obstructing her counterpart's travel plans with 1...Qe6/Qe5/Qe4 met by 2.Qe5+/Qe4+/Qe3+ a different take on the famous Loshinski's magnet this time with queens performing the *pas de deux*. Examination of the details shows the BQ acting as a distant self block /adjacent self block/battery enabling sacrifice to a pawn These are the main features but the nuanced construction is pure wizardry. By play 1...Nc2 /Rxa3 2.Ne6+/Rc5! " Hugely ambitious ideas fulfilled with the greatest virtuosity-that was Lev!"wrote David Friedgood.

A classic Loshinski to solve.

Lev Loshinski D
1 HM L'italia Scchastica 1930



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Critical play': **Key 1.Bc4!**

Readers may send in their queries to
cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com